

5.e) Practice Theory in Anthropology

Anthropology with its rich history of field studies and use of methods like Participant Observation has gathered a lot of theoretical knowledge. Practice theory calls for application of this knowledge for benefit of human kind.

Applied and Action anthropology are two branches that relates to application of theoretical knowledge.

Some illustrations are →

→ Tribal studies conducted by Verrier Elvin and other anthropologists has led to the evolution of policies like Tribal Panchsheel for tribal development.

→ Concepts like NMS Complex have ~~bested~~ presented a model of

tribal development which respects their right over forest resources.

→ Biological anthropology too has been employed by scholars like Franz Boas to bust the myth of racism -

→ Linguistic anthropologists like Prof Ganesh Narayan Levi are using anthropological knowledge to save endangered languages

→ Archaeological anthropology has showed that all human kind has a common origin in Africa and has disproved colonial theories like Aryan Invasion Theory.

Thus, each and every sub-field of anthropology finds real world applications and benefits humanity.